

Community Composting 101



Composting
Systems & the Role
of Community
Composting

Neighborhood
Soil Rebuilders
COMPOSTER TRAINING PROGRAM

ILSR
INSTITUTE FOR
Local Self-Reliance

Composting Systems & the Role of Community Composting

- ✓ Composting Scales & Systems
- ✓ Define Community Composting
- ✓ Examples of Community Composting
- ✓ The Importance of Training

Composting: lots of ways & sizes



MD Environmental Services' Facility (Prince George's County)



Backyard in Takoma Park, MD



Farm in Fairfax, VA



University of Maryland Research Farm (CMREC)



The Farm at Kelly Miller Middle School in DC



ECO City Farms near Washington, DC



Only relying on large-scale & far-away sites...



Recology, serving San Francisco



Cedar Grove, Seattle Region

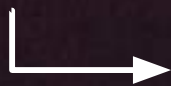


Peninsula, served the Mid-Atlantic (now closed)



...makes it harder to improve local soil!

**Needs
organic
matter!**



A sad
planter bed in
Washington, D.C.



Source: "The
Simple Way
We Might Turn
Food Scraps
Into Energy,"
NBC News,
2017.

Image: Robert
Barker / Cornell
University

Hierarchy to Reduce Food Waste and Grow Community



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Hierarchy to Reduce Food Waste and Grow Community



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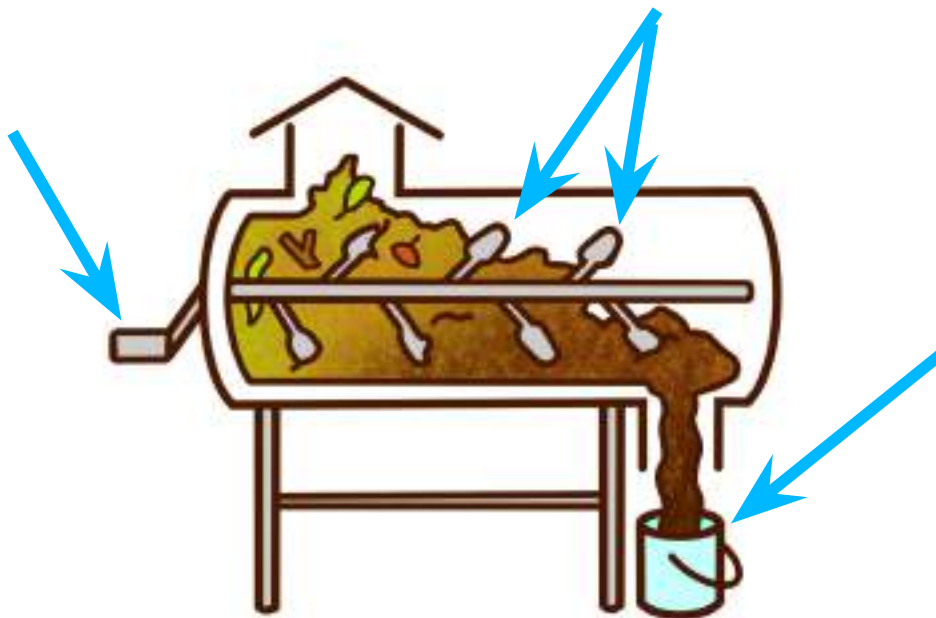
Home Composting



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In-Vessel Systems



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On-Site In-Vessel Systems

The Rocket Composter

Photos:
Food Waste
Experts (left)
Rippowan
Cisqua School
website (right)



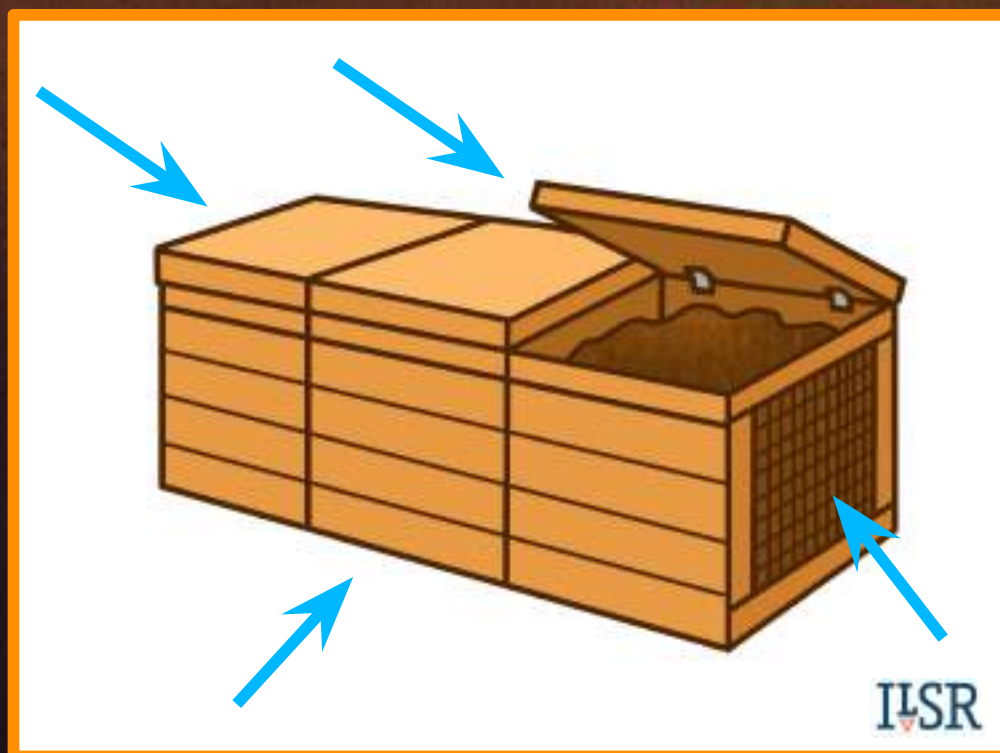
Green Mountain
Technology, Earth Flow system.



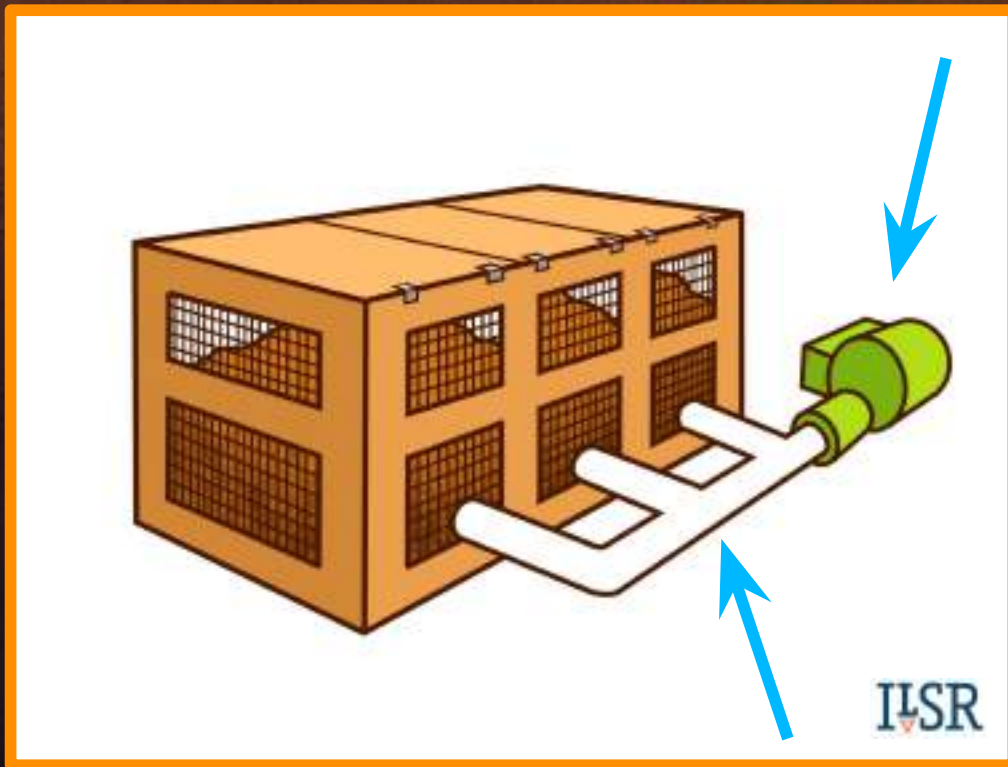
Photos: University
of Maine (Orono).



Multiple Bin Systems

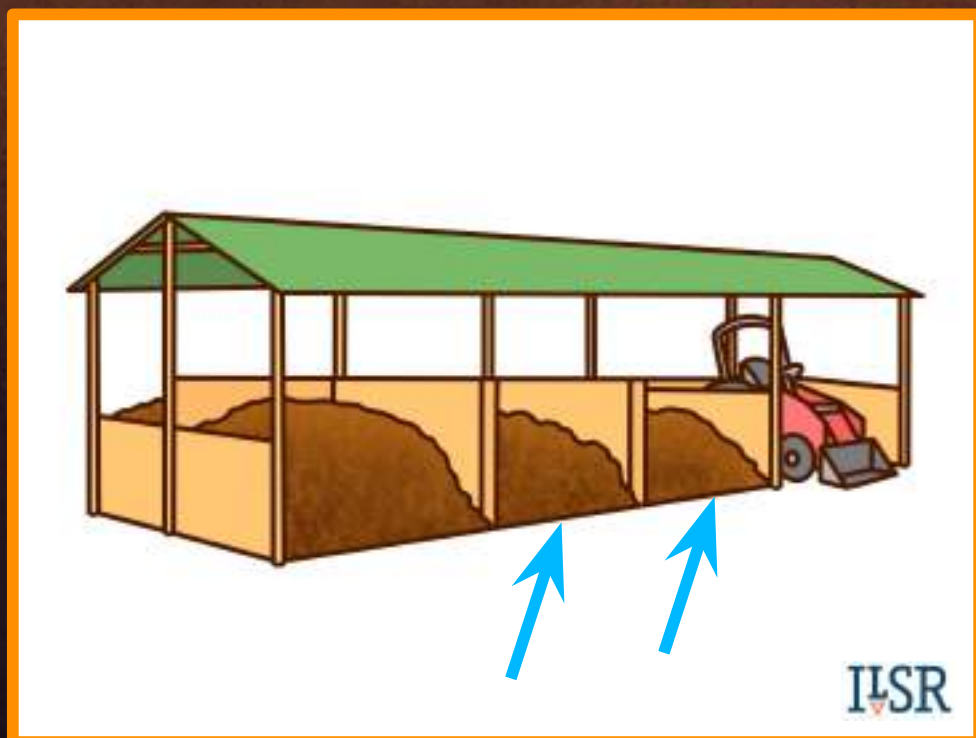


Bin System with Blower



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Bay Systems



Passively Aerated Windrow Systems (PAWS)

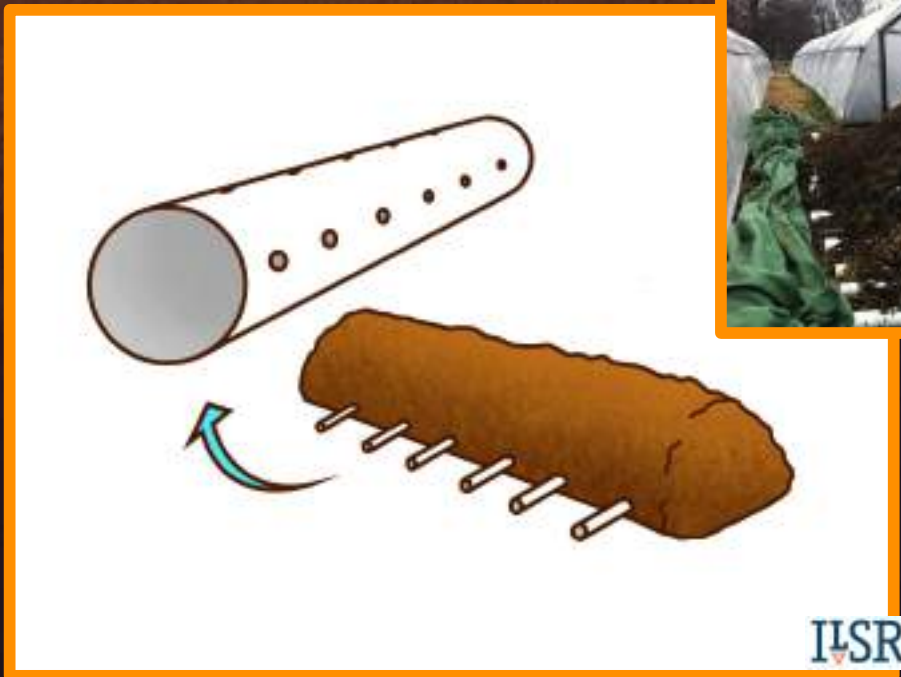


Photo: ECO City Farms

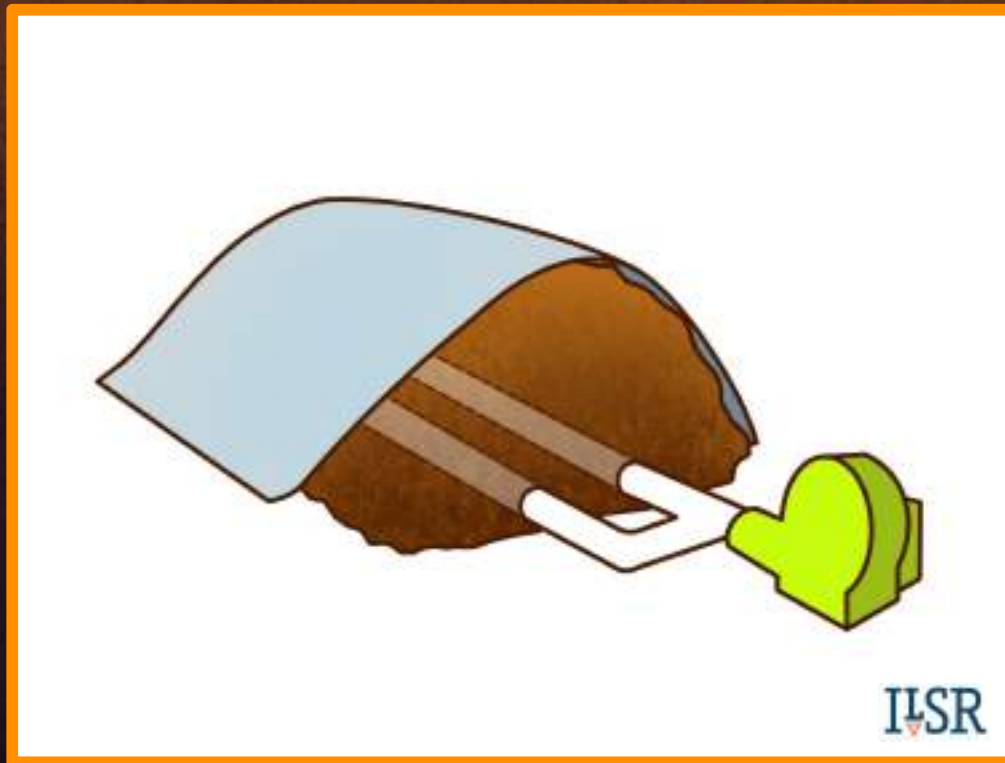
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Aerated Static Piles (ASP)



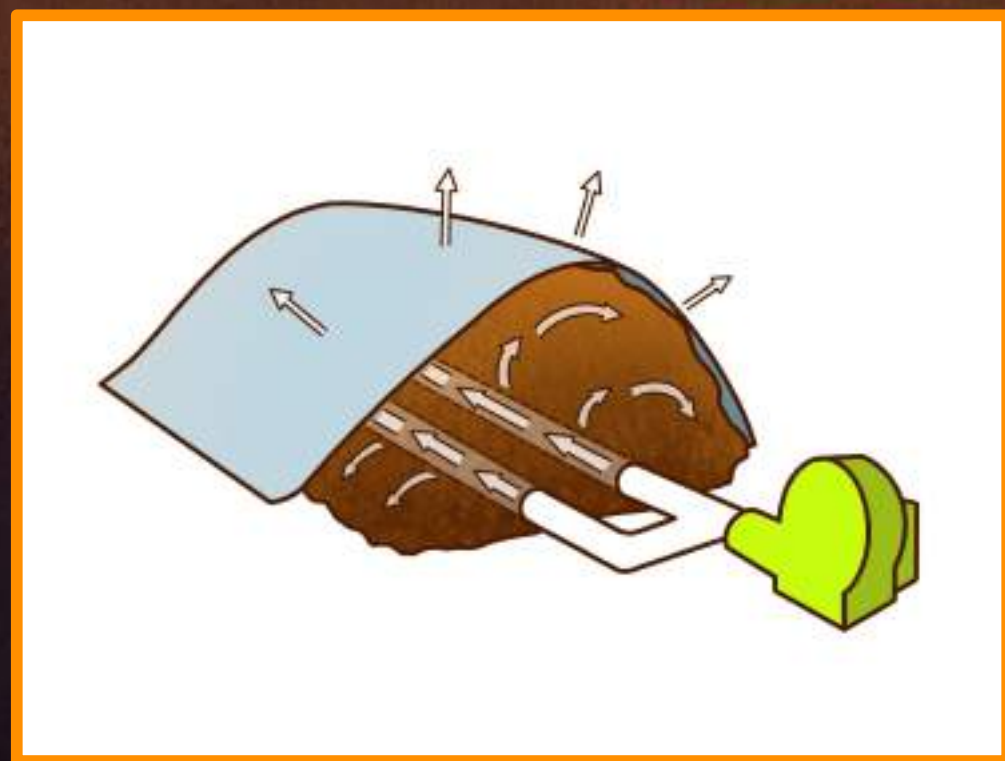
Photo: O2 Compost

Aerated Static Piles (ASP)



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Aerated Static Piles (ASP)



Large-Scale ASP

Prince George's County Organics Composting Facility (Upper Marlboro, MD)

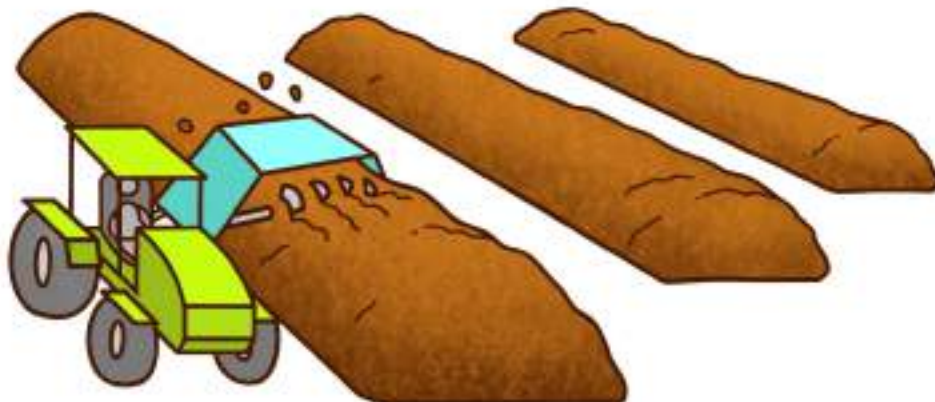


Aerated Static Piles (ASP) with GORE covers.
Photo: Sustainable Generations Project Profile



Composting bunkers used to expand capacity at the site.
Photo: Maryland Environmental Services website

Windrow Systems



Large-Scale Windrows

Montgomery County Composting Facility (Dickerson, MD)



Photos: ILSR



Straddle
windrow
turner

Photo:
Montgomery
County, MD
website



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Hierarchy to Reduce Food Waste and Grow Community



Onsite composting or anaerobic digestion, and community composters can accept material from off-site or simply process their own material.

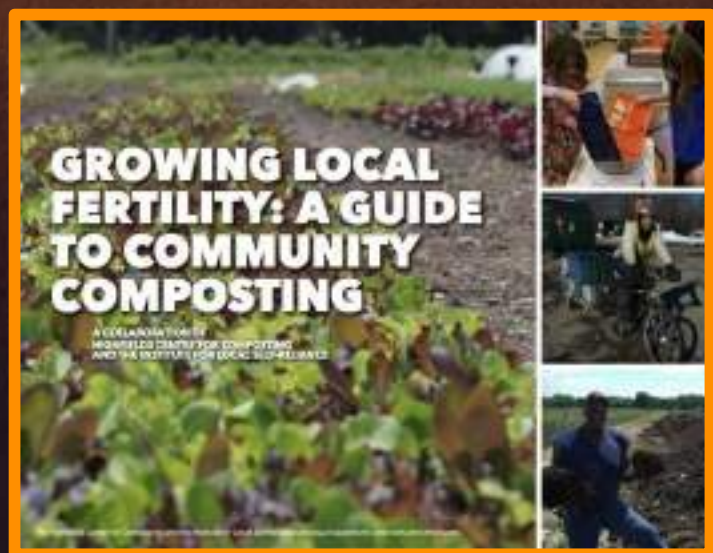


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Community Composting: *Growing Fast!*

- ✓ Resources recovered
- ✓ Locally based and closed loop
- ✓ Organic materials returned to soils
- ✓ Community-scaled & diverse
- ✓ Community engaged, empowered, & educated
- ✓ Community supported



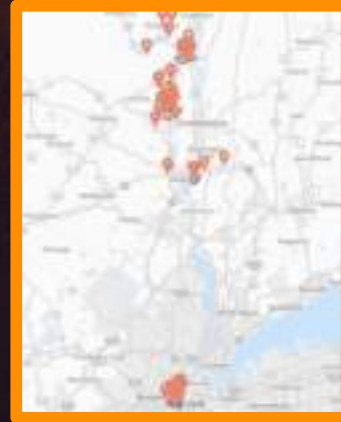
What is Community Composting?

“Community composting keeps the process and product as local as possible while engaging the community through participation and education.”



Food scrap drop-off locations in NYC during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Source: Common Ground Compost @CommonCompost



Food scrap collection locations in the Hudson Valley and Northern New Jersey (2020)

Source: Community Compost Co



Types of Community Composting Programs

1. Community gardens
2. Farms
3. Schools
4. Drop-off networks
5. Collection entrepreneurs
6. On-site composters
7. Off-site composters
8. Demonstration and community leader training sites
9. Worker-owned cooperatives
10. Home-based or homesteader hubs



Reclaimed Organics, a project of Common Ground Compost collects organics by bike from residences and businesses in NYC.

Photo: @CommonCompost



Compost Cab is a food scrap collection service in DC and Baltimore that composts at local community gardens and urban farms.

Photo: @CompostCab

Source: *Growing Local Fertility: A Guide to Community Composting*, ILSR, 2014



ECO City Farms

Prince George's County, Maryland



Photos: ILSR
Chris Cano (bottom left)

Photos: ECO City Farms



Community Compost Company

Hudson Valley, NY



Photos: Community Compost Company @CommunityCompostCo and @HudsonSoil Company



Ramona Unified School District

San Diego County, California

2014-2015

- Source reduction = 2,860 lbs
- Fed people = 7,280 lbs
- Fed animals = 3,840 lbs
- Composted = 6,576 lbs

A cost benefit >\$18,000 in 2015



Green Mountain Technology's Earth Tub In-Vessel Composting System



Source: Gloria Quinn, Ramona Unified School District, "School District Implements Food Recovery Hierarchy," BioCycle, April 6, 2016, San Diego.



St. John's University

New York City



Photos:
ILSR



Photos:
St. John's
University



Worker-Owned Cooperatives



Image: Alyce Santoro



Worker-Owned Cooperatives

The podcast cover features a top image of colorful vegetable scraps in a compost bin. The title 'How Community Composting Disrupts Big Waste (Episode 61)' is prominently displayed. Below the title is a player interface with 'Download' and 'Share' buttons. A short description follows, mentioning Terry Criswell and his work with 'Furgle Around'. A photo of Terry Criswell is shown at the bottom right.

How Community Composting Disrupts Big Waste (Episode 61)

Podcast on **Building Local Power**. [Listen now online](#) | [Download](#) | [Subscribe](#)

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In this episode, host **Brenda Platt** speaks with Terry Criswell. Terry founded **Furgle Around**, a worker-owned cooperative collecting and composting food scraps on a small scale in Oklahoma City. They discuss the power of community composting to transform the monopolized waste system and build up the local economy by reducing food waste, creating jobs, and consolidating private profits.

Terry got started in his own backyard by composting scraps from his garden and using the resulting soil to grow food with neighbors in a community garden. Today, he's in demand for his services and is part of the growing community compost movement across the country. Brenda and Terry also discuss worker-owned cooperatives and how setting

Building Local Power

ABOUT

Building Local Power offers thought-provoking conversations and new ideas for breaking the hold of corporate monopolies and expanding the power of communities to chart their own future.

Every two weeks, we bring you interviews with trailblazing lawmakers, scholars, business leaders, and advocates, plus conversations with local leaders, on-the-ground experts, who share their latest research and reporting.

SUBSCRIBE

Subscribe to the podcast feed: [iTunes](#), [Stitcher](#), or [RSS/ATOM](#). New episodes are published bi-weekly on Thursdays at 10 AM EST.

This section contains two webinar resource cards. The top card is titled 'Webinar Resources: Entity Structure for Community Composters' and features a diagram showing different legal entity structures like 'Exempt Non-Profit', 'For-Profit', and '501(c)(3)'. The bottom card is titled 'Webinar Resources: Two Business Models for Community Composting' and includes a photo of a green compost bin.

Webinar Resources: Entity Structure for Community Composters

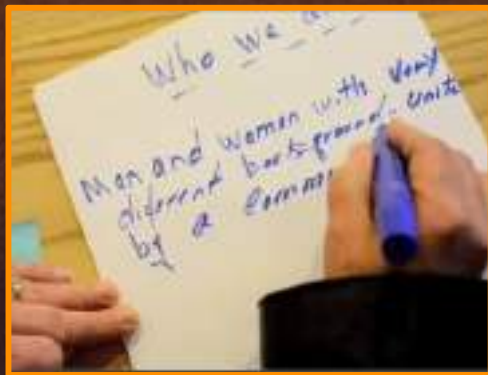
Webinar Resources: Two Business Models for Community Composting

<https://ilsr.org/tag/composting-webinars>

<https://ilsr.org/building-local-power/>



CERO Boston Area



Green jobs in the community

CERO worker-owners are local residents who take pride in their role as environmental stewards, keeping their neighborhoods green and prosperous.

CERO investors support:

- environmental justice
- socially responsible profits
- living wage jobs in democratic workplaces
- zero waste innovation
- local food & solidarity economy



Photos: CERO website, Lor Holmes



Bike-Powered Collection!



Services utilizing bikes pulling trailers are starting up all over the U.S. Entrepreneurs share lessons learned.

Virginia Streeter and Brenda Platt

FOOD scrap collection services have been starting up all over the country, providing an important link between the food industry and the community. These services are not only a way to reduce food waste, but they also provide a source of income for the people who run them. In the United States, food waste is a major problem, with over 40 percent of the food that we produce being thrown away. This is not only a waste of resources, but it also contributes to climate change. By collecting and composting food scraps, these services help to reduce the amount of food waste that ends up in landfills. They also provide a source of income for the people who run them, which is a win-win situation for everyone involved.

Questions asked during the service include: How much food waste is being collected? How often is the collection service being provided? What are the costs of the service? What are the benefits of the service? These are all important questions that need to be answered before a food scrap collection service can be successfully implemented. By asking these questions, entrepreneurs can ensure that their service is meeting the needs of the community and is financially sustainable.

STARTING UP

While each company's start-up is unique, there are some common steps that all companies should follow. First, entrepreneurs need to identify the needs of the community. This can be done by talking to local residents, businesses, and organizations. Next, entrepreneurs need to develop a business plan. This plan should include information about the costs of the service, the benefits of the service, and the marketing strategy. Finally, entrepreneurs need to launch the service. This can be done by reaching out to the community and offering the service for free or at a low cost. By following these steps, entrepreneurs can ensure that their food scrap collection service is successful and sustainable.



Source: Virginia Streeter & Brenda Platt (ILSR), "Bike Powered Food Scraps Collection," BioCycle, January 12, 2017.



Bike-Powered Collection!



Pedal-Powered Composters Support Local Food Movement (feat. Tilthy Rich Compost) – Episode #2

ilsr.org/composting-for-community-podcast-homepage/



Webinar Resources: Bike-Powered Food Scrap Collection – Spotlight on Equipment

ilsr.org/tag/composting-webinars



BK ROT Brooklyn, NYC

Photo: @BK_Rot



Windrows



Photo: @BK_Rot

Bike collection



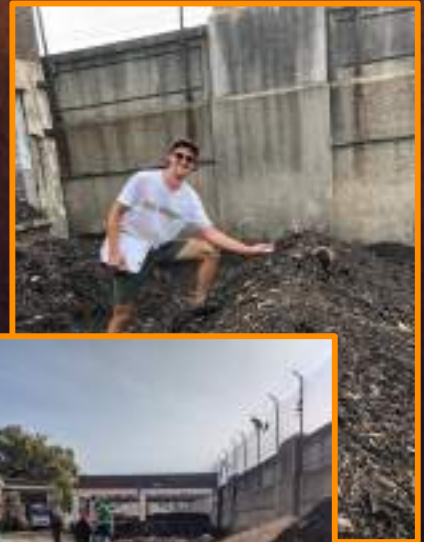
Photo: Valery Rizzo



Bennett Compost Philadelphia



Source: @BennettCompost



Source: ILSR



Bennett Compost Philadelphia



Two Particular Acres in Royersford, PA



Students at Saul
Agricultural High School
Photos: @BennettCompost



Red Hook Community Farm



Photos: David Buckel, Red Hook Community Farm Compost Operation



Drop-Off Programs

- Farmers markets
- Community gardens
- City parks
- Multi-material recycling drop-off sites
- Transfer stations
- Municipal buildings (e.g. DPW)
- Compost facilities



Food scrap drop-off in Falls Church, VA, operated by Veteran Compost.
Photos: ILSR



DPR Community Compost Cooperative Network District of Columbia

Urban Farm
Plans'
Compost
Knox 3-bin
composting
system

Photos:
ILSR



Map: DC Department of Parks & Recreation

ILSR

DPW Food Waste Drop-Off Program District of Columbia



Source: DC Department of Public Works

ILSR

Compost Cab

Washington, D.C. & Baltimore



Photos: @CompostCab
Photos: Compost Cab

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Volunteers & Trained Operators Are Critical

The NYC Compost Project cultivates community leaders through its Master Composter Certificate Program.

These leaders volunteer their time to conduct public workshops, provide community outreach, bring people to gardens, and spread compost.



Photos: NYC Compost Project





Rebuilding our soil,
neighborhood
by neighborhood.

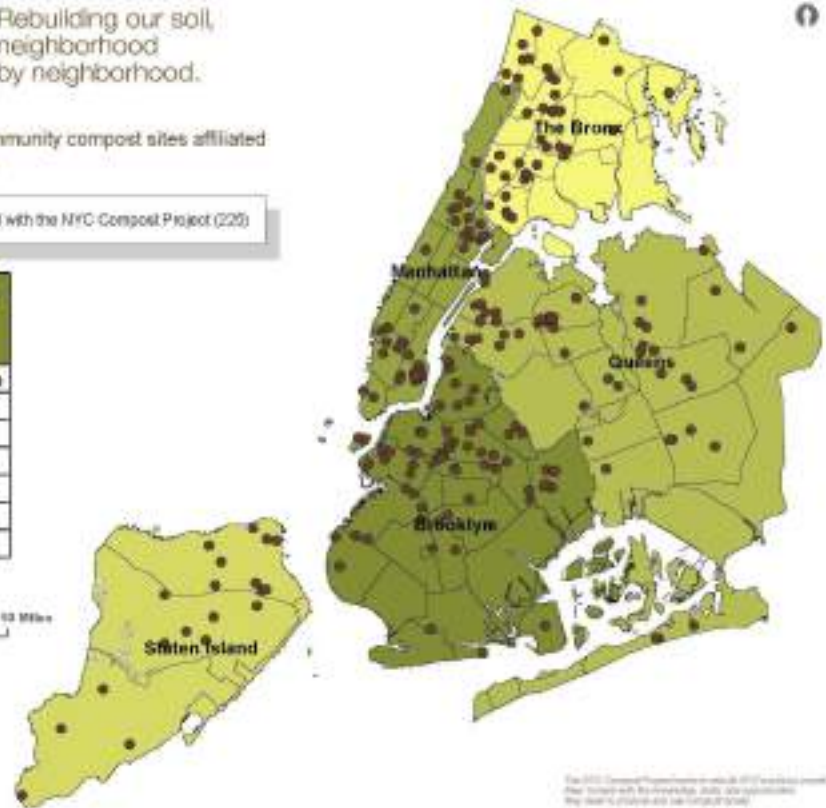
Included in this map are all community compost sites affiliated with the NYC Compost Project.

● Community Compost Sites Affiliated with the NYC Compost Project (225)

Community Compost Sites
Affiliated with the NYC
Compost Project

Borough	Total per Borough
Brooklyn	68
Bronx	37
Manhattan	48
Queens	52
Staten Island	20
Total	225

0 5 10 Miles



The NYC Compost Project is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. All proceeds from the sale of compost go to the NYC Compost Project. The NYC Compost Project is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. All proceeds from the sale of compost go to the NYC Compost Project.



Neighborhood Soil Rebuilders Composter Training Program



Learn more at: ilsr.org/neighborhoodsoilrebuilders/



Howard University Compost Cooperative Farm at Kelly Miller Middle School DC

Rebuilder: Jeffrey Neal

Systems Used: multi-bin, worm composting, Ridan in-vessel



Photos: ILSR,

Pictured: Jeffrey Neil at the Howard University Community Compost Cooperative



Greenbelt Compost Cooperative Greenbelt, MD

Rebuilder:
Beth Leamond

System Used:
3-bin Compost
Knox and worm
composting bins



Pictured:
Beth
Leamond (far
right) &
cooperative
members

Photos: ILSR



Key City Compost Frederick, MD

Rebuilder:

Phil Westcott



Pictured: Phil Westcott (right) & Key City Compost

Photos: Key City Compost



The Role of Community Composting

- ✓ **Composting Scales & Systems**
- ✓ **Defined Community Composting**
- ✓ **Examples of Community Composting**
- ✓ **The Importance of Training**



Source: @LA Compost



Composting Fundamentals & Recipe Development

- ✓ The Compost Pile Food Web
- ✓ Types of Composting
- ✓ Important Ingredients
- ✓ Developing a Composting Recipe
- ✓ Temperature & The Stages of Composting